

Paragraph / section function - Workbook 2

Focused practice - Workbook 2 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Rain Garden Trial

A school article first explains that water pools beside the gym after heavy rain. The second section describes how students and maintenance staff built a shallow rain garden. The third reports that standing water disappeared faster during the next three storms.

1. What is the main function of this paragraph or section?

- A. reports the result of the response described in the previous section
- B. summarizes the entire passage without serving a specific local role
- C. introduces a new topic unrelated to the surrounding discussion
- D. gives background information that does not connect to the passage's main development

2. How does this part contribute to the larger text?

- A. It changes the topic rather than developing the writer's explanation.
- B. It supplies outcome evidence showing whether the rain garden addressed the drainage problem.
- C. It repeats the previous sentence with no additional purpose.
- D. It gives information that conflicts with the surrounding paragraphs.

Late Shift Memo

A manager lists benefits of allowing employees to swap late shifts through an app. A later paragraph notes that workers without smartphones can still request changes through a supervisor.

3. What is the main function of this paragraph or section?

- A. summarizes the entire passage without serving a specific local role
- B. introduces a new topic unrelated to the surrounding discussion
- C. addresses a limitation or access concern in the proposed system
- D. gives background information that does not connect to the passage's main development

4. How does this part contribute to the larger text?

- A. It changes the topic rather than developing the writer's explanation.
- B. It repeats the previous sentence with no additional purpose.
- C. It gives information that conflicts with the surrounding paragraphs.
- D. It qualifies the app-focused plan by explaining an alternative for employees who cannot use it.

Museum Labels

An exhibit guide explains that early museum labels often contained long technical descriptions. It then quotes a modern label of only forty words and explains how designers now use maps and images to carry some of the information.

5. What is the main function of this paragraph or section?

- A. illustrates the change with a specific modern example
- B. summarizes the entire passage without serving a specific local role
- C. introduces a new topic unrelated to the surrounding discussion
- D. gives background information that does not connect to the passage's main development

6. How does this part contribute to the larger text?

- A. It changes the topic rather than developing the writer's explanation.
- B. The example makes the shift toward shorter, more visual labels concrete.
- C. It repeats the previous sentence with no additional purpose.
- D. It gives information that conflicts with the surrounding paragraphs.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. It supplies outcome evidence showing whether the rain garden addressed the drainage problem.
2. B. It supplies outcome evidence showing whether the rain garden addressed the drainage problem.
3. C. It qualifies the app-focused plan by explaining an alternative for employees who cannot use it.
4. D. It qualifies the app-focused plan by explaining an alternative for employees who cannot use it.
5. A. The example makes the shift toward shorter, more visual labels concrete.
6. B. The example makes the shift toward shorter, more visual labels concrete.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.